

58.2 MAKING OFFERS

"Can" and "may" can also be used to offer to do something for someone.

Can I help you carry those?

Yes, please.



"May" is only used for formal situations.

May I take your coat?

Yes, thank you.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

Can I get you a drink?

That would be lovely.



My computer's broken again!

Can I help at all?



Good evening.
May I take your order?

Yes, please.



Which way is the elevator?

It's on the left.
May I help you with your bags?



58.3 SHALL FOR OFFERS AND SUGGESTIONS

"Shall" is used to find out if someone thinks a certain suggestion is a good idea. This is not often used in US English.

That bag looks heavy. Shall I carry it for you?

Yes, please.



Shall I open the window?

Good idea. it's far too hot in here.

